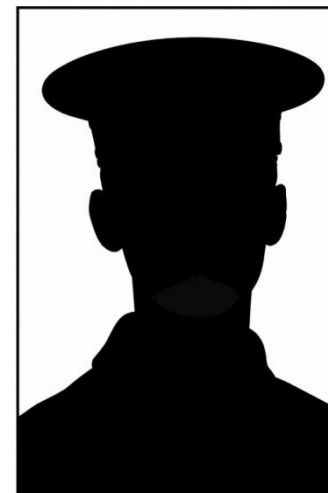




Arthur Akin Higgins

1885 – 1918

Civilian Research

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	Arthur Akin Higgins	CWGC and Probate (for first names) see below as well as RVC obit All the proof below points to this man
Date of Birth	Born 11 Dec 1885 Kidderpore, Bengal, India and Bpt 1/1/1886 Bengal	Ancestry – India: select births and baptisms 1786-1947 transcript – see below
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	25/10/1918	CWGC (note: Spreadsheet date of death is out by 2 months)
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	32	CWGC
Marital Status	None as far as I could see on researching and none mentioned on obits	

Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	Veterinarian	
Parents	Son of Mildred Akin Higgins, of Fairholme, Green Hill, Harrow Arthur Akin Higgins his father – why isn't father mentioned in any of the news pieces or the RVC obit? But is mentioned in probate?	CWGC Probate
Listed Address(s)	1911 boarding with a family in Hounslow (see below) 1901 a boarder at Grammar School in Hitchin, Herts after JLS 1891 living 7 Comiston Rd, Edinburgh where his father is described as a Tourist Agent	1901 census Mentions JLS in RVC obit below 1891 Scottish census transcript on FMP
Parents /Fathers occupation	Varies 1891 a Tourist Agent see news articles below	1891 Scottish census
Brothers and Sisters	Dorothy Higgins (older), William Henry Higgins (younger) – also both born in India	1891 Scottish Census transcript (FMP) and India: select births and baptisms 1786-1947 transcript (Ancestry)
Years at John Lyon School	1895-1900	https://www.sommemidulster.org/cwd/pdfs/04055.pdf
University (if any)	Royal Veterinary College	
Obituary	See below – they all mention he was a captain in the RAVC – veterinary corps	
	Biographical list of students/staff of the RVC who died in Great War incl Arthur – mentions JLS	https://www.sommemidulster.org/cwd/pdfs/04055.pdf
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School, plaque	as A Higgins

	John Lyon School, sundial	as A Higgins
	Not on Harrow on the Hill memorial	
	Not on St Peter's or St John the Baptist	

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	HIGGINS A.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/334462/higgins,-/
Age	32
DoD	25-Aug-18
Rank	Capt
Regiment	Army Veterinary Corps
Organisations must have served or have members who served in the Ypres Salient or the Somme in World War One.	
Location	DOIRAN MILITARY CEMETERY Greece
Military details	M.I.D. (Mentioned in Despatches) Son of Mildred Akin Higgins, of Harrow, Middx. According to the Royal (Dick) Veterinary College Roll Captain Arthur Akin Higgins of the Army Veterinary Corps (later the Royal Army Veterinary Corps) died of bronchial pneumonia following influenza on October 25, 1918, in the Balkan theater (Salonica campaign). He was commissioned as a temporary Lieutenant in October 1916 and promoted to Captain while serving with the Army Veterinary Corps. He spent two years in the Balkans attached to the 115th Brigade, Royal Field Artillery. He contracted the Spanish flu during the global pandemic and died of disease (bronchopneumonia). His death occurred just a month after peace was declared on the Balkan front. He was 32 years old. He is buried at the Doiran Military Cemetery in Greece. The cemetery is located near the North Macedonian border, where heavy fighting took place during the Salonica campaign. He was the son of Mildred Akin Higgins of Harrow, Middlesex. He was an educated veterinarian who qualified MRCVS from the Royal (Dick) Veterinary College in Edinburgh in May 1910.

Story of Sacrifice

Arthur Akin Higgins (1885–1918)

Arthur Akin Higgins (1885–1918)

Arthur Akin Higgins was a qualified veterinarian who served as a Captain in the Army Veterinary Corps, spending two years with the British forces in the Balkans during the First World War. He died of bronchial pneumonia following influenza in Salonika on 25 October 1918, aged 32, and was buried at Doiran Military Cemetery in Greece.

Civilian Life

Arthur was born on 11 December 1885 at Kidderpore, Bengal, India, and was baptised there on 1 January 1886. He was the son of Arthur Akin Higgins and Mildred Akin Higgins. (Some explanation as to why he was born in India can be found in his Father's story below.) In 1891, the family was living at 7 Comiston Road, Edinburgh, where his father was recorded as a tourist agent. Arthur had an older sister, Dorothy, and a younger brother, William Henry, both of whom were also born in India. Arthur was educated at the Lower School of John Lyon School, Harrow, from 1895 to 1900, and subsequently attended Hitchin Grammar School in Hertfordshire. He went on to study veterinary medicine at the Royal Veterinary College in Edinburgh and qualified as a Member of the Royal College of Veterinary Surgeons (MRCVS) in May 1910. By 1911, Arthur was living as a boarder with a family in Hounslow. His occupation was recorded as a veterinarian. In 1915, the electoral register shows him at the same Hounslow address, 37 Bulstrode Road, where furnished accommodation and board cost 23 shillings per week.

Military Life

Arthur Higgins entered military service during the First World War and was commissioned as a temporary Lieutenant in the Army Veterinary Corps in October 1916. He served for two years in the Balkans, attached to the 115th Brigade, Royal Field Artillery, and was promoted to Captain. His service took place during the Salonika campaign. He was Mentioned in Despatches, having been brought to notice by General George Milne, the Commander-in-Chief of the British Salonika Army. The dispatch was submitted to the Secretary of State for War to acknowledge "gallant and distinguished services" rendered during the final stages of the Balkan campaign.

Arthur died from bronchial pneumonia following influenza during the global Spanish Flu pandemic at a casualty clearing station in Salonika on 25 October 1918, aged 32. The date is confirmed by his probate record, death notice, and the Royal Veterinary College's biographical record, despite a conflicting date appearing in one casualty listing. Arthur died only about a month after peace had been declared on the Balkan front. He was buried at Doiran Military Cemetery in Greece. He is also commemorated by the John Lyon School and the Royal Veterinary College. His probate record recorded effects of £140, with administration granted in London in July 1919.

The Story of Arthur's Father

Arthur's father, also named Arthur Akin Higgins, had a notably varied life. He was recorded in 1891 as a tourist agent and had travelled extensively, making several journeys to Egypt, the Nile and Palestine and, according to a 1920 newspaper report, travelling around the world nine times. During the latter part of the First World War, he served as temporary British Vice-Consul at Bergen, Norway. After completing theological training at Ely, he took an unexpected further step in his life. In 1920, at the age of 65, he was ordained at St Paul's Cathedral by special permission of the Bishop of London. He subsequently became assistant curate at St Peter's, Harrow, where he had already been attached to the parish. Arthur senior later died in 1927 and was buried in the Protestant Cemetery in Rome.

Photos

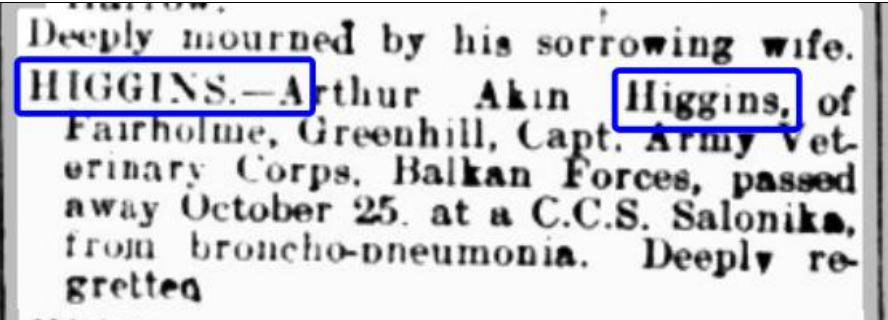
Doiran Military Cemetery, Doirani, Regional unit of Kilkis, Central Macedonia, Greece

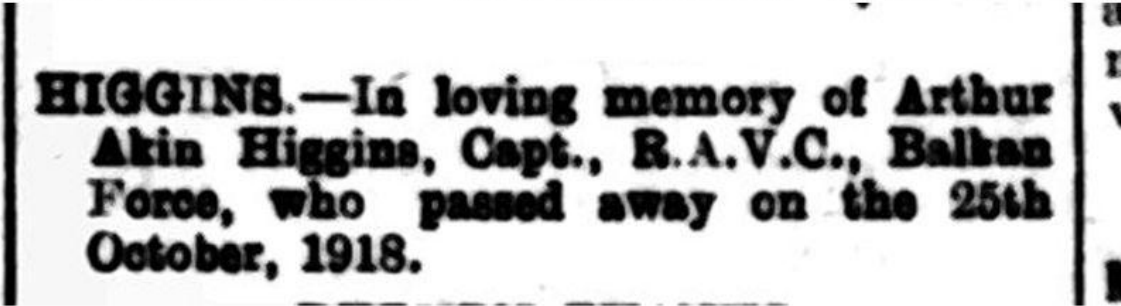


Notes and Clippings

Electoral Register, Hounslow, 1915 – same address in 1911 census where he was a boarder	
	Electoral Register, Hounslow, 1915 – same address in 1911 census where he was a boarder H 1004 Higgins, Arthur Akin ... 1 room, 1st floor, 1 room ground floor, furnished 37, Bulstrode-road, Hounslow 23s. per week including board Mr. Rudge, of 37, Bulstrode-road, Hounslow.

Royal Veterinary College WW1 biographical roll of those who died in Great War – mentions JLS https://www.sommemidulster.org/cwd/pdfs/04055.pdf The asterisk indicates that he was not included in the original war memorial at the college – only added later after research and a new plaque erected in 2014 (see link above) with more names	
*HIGGINS, Arthur Akin. Captain, Army Veterinary Corps Arthur Akin Higgins was the son of Mrs Mildred Akin Higgins of Harrow, Middlesex. He was educated at the Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow from 1895 to 1900 and later at Hitchin Grammer School, Hertfordshire. He qualified MRCVS from the Royal (Dick) Veterinary College in May 1910. He was commissioned as a temporary Lieutenant in the Army Veterinary Corps in October 1916 and served for two years in the Balkans where he was attached to 115th Brigade, Royal Field Artillery and was promoted to Captain. He died of bronchial pneumonia following influenza aged 32 on 25th October 1918 a month after the declaration of peace on the Balkan front. He is buried in Doiran Military Cemetery, Greece.	Royal Veterinary College WW1 biographical roll of those who died in Great War – mentions JLS https://www.sommemidulster.org/cwd/pdfs/04055.pdf *HIGGINS, Arthur Akin. Captain, Army Veterinary Corps Arthur Akin Higgins was the son of Mrs Mildred Akin Higgins of Harrow, Middlesex. He was educated at the Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow from 1895 to 1900 and later at Hitchin Grammer School, Hertfordshire. He qualified MRCVS from the Royal (Dick) Veterinary College in May 1910. He was commissioned as a temporary Lieutenant in the Army Veterinary Corps in October 1916 and served for two years in the Balkans where he was attached to 115th Brigade, Royal Field Artillery and was promoted to Captain. He died of bronchial pneumonia following influenza aged 32 on 25th October 1918 a month after the declaration of peace on the Balkan front. He is buried in Doiran Military Cemetery, Greece. The asterisk indicates that he was not included in the original war memorial at the college – only added later after research and a new plaque erected in 2014 (see link above) with more names

Harrow Observer 1/11/1918 Death notice	
 Deeply mourned by his sorrowing wife. HIGGINS.—Arthur Akin Higgins, of Fairholme, Greenhill, Capt. Army Vet- erinary Corps, Balkan Forces, passed away October 25. at a C.C.S. Salonika, from broncho-pneumonia. Deeply re- gretted	Harrow Observer 1/11/1918 Death notice HIGGINS.—Arthur Akin Higgins, of Fairholme, Greenhill, Capt. Army Vet- erinary Corps, Balkan Forces, passed away October 25. at a C.C.S. Salonika, from broncho-pneumonia. Deeply regretted

Harrow Observer 24/10/1919 – this is an in memoriam – he died one year before	
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Probate 1919	
HIGGINS Arthur Akin of Fairholme Green-hill Harrow Middlesex died 25 October 1918 at Salonika Administration London 26 July to Arthur Akin Higgins retired captain Indian Army. Effects £140.	HIGGINS Arthur Akin of Fairholme Green-hill Harrow Middlesex died 25 October 1918 at Salonika Administration London 26 July to Arthur Akin Higgins retired captain Indian Army. Effects £140.

From the Centenary issue of the <i>Lyonian</i>, researched by pupils 2014	
Higgins, A A Arthur A Higgins was a captain of the Army Veterinary Corps who died of bronchial pneumonia on 25th October 1918 aged 32. The <i>Lyonian</i> said that "one can hardly realise that a man of such splendid physique would go under." Where he had been fighting in Bulgaria peace had already been declared and "one would have hoped his life would have been spared." He had served for two years fighting in the Balkans. He was the son of Mildred Akin Higgins, of Harrow, Middlesex. He is remembered at Doiran Military Cemetery, Serbia.	From the Centenary issue of the Lyonian, researched by pupils 2014 Higgins, A A Arthur A Higgins was a captain of the Army Veterinary Corps who died of bronchial pneumonia on 25th October 1918 aged 32. The <i>Lyonian</i> said that "one can hardly realise that a man of such splendid physique would go under." Where he had been fighting in Bulgaria peace had already been declared and "one would have hoped his life would have been spared." He had served for two years fighting in the Balkans. He was the son of Mildred Akin Higgins, of Harrow, Middlesex. He is remembered at Doiran Military Cemetery, Serbia.

A boy named G. Akin-Higgins (Sub-Editor) was listed in the *Lyonian* dated 1912 – long after Arthur Akin Higgins would have left as he would have been 26 in 1912. So was G. Akin-Higgins a much younger brother not listed in the table above.

Notes about his Father

Father's Death notice 1927	
HIGGINS the reverend Arthur Akin of Fairholme House Harrow Middlesex clerk died 6 April 1927 at 87 Via Flaminia Rome Italy Administration (with Will) (limited) London 10 February to Westminster Bank limited the attorney of Boston Safe Deposit & Trust Company. Effects £948 14s. 1d.	

Arthur's birth/bpt in India (Ancestry) – confirmed by 1911 census where he says he was born in Calcutta

Detail ⓘ

Name	Arthur Akin-Higgins
Gender	Male
Race	White
Birth Date	11 Dec 1885
Baptism Date	01 Jan 1886
Baptism Age	0 [0]
Baptism Place	Kidderpore, Bengal, India
Father	Arthur Akin-Higgins
Mother	Mildred Sarah
FHL Film Number	510878

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– Daily Chronicle 4/10/1920

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IT'S NEVER TOO LATE TO—
BECOME A CLERGYMAN.

Among those ordained at St. Paul's Cathedral yesterday, by special permission of the Bishop of London, was Mr. Arthur Akin Higgins, of Fairholme, Harrow, who is 65 years of age.

He has been nine times round the world. During the latter part of the war he acted as temporary British Consul at Bergen, Norway.

He has been attached to St. Peter's, Harrow.

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Harrow Observer 1/10/1920 His father's ordination

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Arthur Higgins senior was buried in Rome, Protestant Cemetery

2452 Zona Terza; Wreath. × × 8

[m] Arthur Akin HIGGINS

*0/0/0 †0/0/1927

Nationality: English

1 south side, good condition, incised,
primary inscription, English

REV. DR.
ARTHUR AKIN HIGGINS
EX VICE CONSUL BERGEN,NORWAY
EX RECTOR OF TORTEVAL,GUERNSEY.C.I.
BORN IN BATH,OCT.10TH 1853 - DIED IN ROME,APRIL 6TH 1927
"HE SHALL GIVE THEE THY HEART'S DESIRE."

Iconography: minor on in general (i16) [5] column, broken

HIGGINS the reverend Arthur Akin of Fairholme House Harrow
Middlesex clerk died 6 April 1927 at 87 Via Flaminia Rome Italy
Administration (with Will) (limited) **London** 10 February to
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